FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-34-24005

Issue Title : 737MAX FMS CPDLC Network Acknowledgement Timer expiration issue

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3461-00	-10, -7, -8, -9
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
06/18/2024	03/27/2026	01/15/2026
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	
01/31/2028	09/30/2026	

Revision Description

Updated the following section(s):

- Milestones.

Description

Boeing has received recent reports from operators asking for clarification regarding the use of the uplink message status, as seen on the ATC Log page and on the XXXXz ATC Uplink page.

In the nominal case, with FMS Operational Software (OPS) U12/U13/U14+ when a NEW uplink is viewed by the flight crew, the message status will transition to OPEN. When the flight crew responds to the uplink, the response prompt will transition to SENDING, and the message status will remain as OPEN until a network acknowledgement uplink for the downlink response is received by the FMC (See Attachment). When this occurs, the message status will transition to ACCEPTED or REJECTED (depending on which response was selected). In rare cases, the network acknowledgement will not be received by the FMC even though the downlink response has been delivered to the intended recipient. When this occurs, the response prompt will remain in SENDING for a period of 5 minutes.

This 5-minute period is defined by an internal FMC timer known as the network acknowledgement timer. Upon expiration of the network acknowledgment timer, the message status will remain as OPEN and the original response prompts will re-display, allowing the flight crew to resend their initial downlink response (See Attachment for example). There is no scratchpad message indication to the flight crew that the uplink message status has remained OPEN and that the response prompts have redisplayed. The uplink will not appear as NEW, nor will it re-trigger the aural alert chime, but ".ATC" will remain on the engine display as long as the uplink message status remains OPEN. The uplink will remain in the ATC Log as OPEN until a subsequent downlink response is sent and a corresponding network acknowledgement uplink is received.

This issue affects both 737NG and 737MAX configurations. 737NG-FTD-34-24002 added as reference.

Status

A design improvement is under consideration for inclusion in the U14.2 Software update. This future design change would

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prevent an uplink from remaining OPEN in the event that a network acknowledgement for the downlink response was not received by the FMC.

Interim Action

Flight crews that identify that the uplink is “OPEN” after exercising the clearance should resolve the “OPEN” uplink with ATC via voice. Refer to the attachment for example on identifying an uplink that remains “OPEN”.

Final Action

There is a proposed design improvement targeted to be included in the FMC U14.2 software update to address this issue.

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

Root Cause Established: Feb 2024 (Completed)
Change Committed: FMC U14.2 Software upgrade
FAA/EASA MAX FMC U14.2 Service Bulletin Available: No earlier than 2028 (Target)

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Fleet Team Digest Article (FTD)	737NG-FTD-34-24002		

Related Categories

- Flight Operations : Flight Operations

Attachments:

a) 5min Network Ack Timer Expiration example

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